via shared language. Language and conceptualisation always go together. As ***Dignaga*** says, 'Speech is born out of conceptual construction and conceptual construction is born out of speech.'

A problem arises when people overlook the purely conventional nature of what are only human ways of thinking and suppose that they correspond to objective realities. Error occurs when conceptual thought takes its own forms to correspond directly to reality. Since reality consists of momentary unique particulars, general concepts cannot represent it exactly. Still, a thought is reliable if it is causally related to the actual object.

See ***Grahya-grahaka-vibhaga***

Vipaksha: in an inference, one of the guarantees of the invariable association of the logical reason with the property to be proved is that there are no instances where the logical reason (***hetu***) occurs and the property to be proved (***sadhya***) does not. If we want to establish the presence of fire on a mountain top and have seen smoke, we would appeal to the general principle that wherever there is smoke there is fire. The kitchen would be a positive example exemplifying the joint presence of the reason and the property to be proved. A lake would be a *vipaksha* in that it constantly exhibits the absence of fire and the absence of smoke. It is not necessary to cite a counter-positive example: what is crucial is that there is no knowledge of any case where the logical reason is found in the absence of the property to be proved.

Viruddha-hetu (contradictory logical reason): a type of fallacy (***hetvabhasa***) in which the logical reason (***hetu***) is defective because it never occurs where the property to be proved (***sadhya***) occurs: that is, it contradicts what one